AI Bootcamp — Week 4: Coaching Readiness & Certification Gate

Friday — Student Exercise Guide

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OBJECTIVES

By end of Week 4, the candidate is cleared for Deep Learning Program (DLP) engagement — meaning they can:

- Deliver the player-coach model in a live pairing session with a Basic Prompting-level developer
- Recognize the difference between real adoption and polite compliance
- Handle the four most common resistance patterns (skeptic, over-truster, identity-protective senior, management blocker)
- Explain EDD, RTCC (WHO/WHAT/WHY/HOW), the load-bearing rule, and the Prompt/Harness/Model framework clearly to a developer who has never heard of any of them
- Produce artifacts that a client can use after the Embedded Engineer is gone
- Articulate the full DLP arc: two 6-week loops, 6 Trainer sessions landing at weeks 1/3/5/7/9/11, the introduce-then-reinforce cadence, the transfer model (workspace to real codebase), and the Stage 3 to Stage 4 trajectory
- Operate their half of the two-person delivery model: Trainer touchpoints, escalation rules, and the Week 12 joint rubric
- Pass the Certification Gate

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TIMING

- **Monday–Friday:** 9:00 AM – 5:00 PM with 1-hour lunch (7 hours each day)

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FRIDAY (9:00 AM – 5:00 PM): CERTIFICATION GATE

9:00 AM – 12:00 PM — FINAL SUBMISSION AND CANDIDATE SELF-ASSESSMENT

Candidates finalize and submit all artifacts. The written self-assessment against DLP Completion criteria (Craft, Evaluate, Iterate, Adopt) must be submitted by 12:00 PM.

Self-assessment guidance: For each criterion, provide:

- One specific artifact that demonstrates this criterion
- One specific example of using it in real work (not a program exercise)
- An honest assessment of where you are still developing

12:00 – 1:00 PM — LUNCH

1:00 – 3:00 PM — REVIEWER EVALUATION

Program manager reviews submitted artifacts and self-assessment. Candidate is available for questions.

3:00 – 5:00 PM — CERTIFICATION GATE DECISION AND FEEDBACK

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CERTIFICATION GATE

To be cleared for DLP engagement, the Embedded Engineer candidate must submit:

ARTIFACTS (ALL COMMITTED, ALL PASSING HANDOFF CHECKLIST)

These mirror what the EE Implementation Guide requires of a certified Embedded Engineer: at least one skill with `disable-model-invocation: true`, one Python evaluation script with an LLM judge, and one adversarial agent prompt, all built personally.

From Weeks 1–2 (EDD and RTCC):

- [ ] Manual EC test file (Input Prompts + Expected Outputs) written before the skill was built (at least one, Trend Identification or equivalent; commit order will be checked)
- [ ] Four RTCC skill files from the Week 1 pipeline (Trend ID, Ideation, Development, Graphics), with `disable-model-invocation: true`
- [ ] Python evaluation scripts with baseline + 3+ iteration results and documented hypotheses for at least 3 skills
- [ ] Load-bearing audit documentation: at least 2 skills with removed instructions documented
- [ ] Seven SDLC skill files from Week 2, built out from the DLP student-workspace skeletons, all with completed Context (WHY) and Constraints (HOW)
- [ ] Upstream quality dependency trace: at least one documented case

From Week 3 (Invocation, Adversarial Agents, Bounded Agents):

- [ ] One skill graduated to invocation-enabled, with the three graduation criteria documented and invocation test cases (3 positive trigger, 2 negative, 2 quality), OR a written gap specification explaining what the skill has not yet earned
- [ ] One adversarial agent prompt with documented findings, plus an evaluator-vs-adversarial comparison on the same outputs
- [ ] One bounded agent run: a chained pipeline executed in a single session with evaluation at the checkpoints

DOCUMENTATION

- [ ] Automation spectrum assessment: written evaluation of artifacts against the v2 spectrum criteria (invocation-disabled skills → invocation-enabled skills → adversarial agents → bounded agents → custom harnesses)
- [ ] Earn-the-next-step explanation paragraph (manager-audience, coaching-ready)
- [ ] Behavior change reflection: which artifacts are in active daily use, with evidence
- [ ] Artifact handoff review: checklist completed for all artifacts

DEMONSTRATED SKILLS

- [ ] Python evaluation demonstrated live, not explained: run a script, interpret the results, state what change the results justify
- [ ] Player-coach session observed or recorded (Thursday rehearsal)

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- [ ] All four resistance scenario role plays completed (Tuesday)
- [ ] EDD explanation delivered to a non-expert and debriefed (Monday)
- [ ] Behavior change observation session completed (Thursday)
- [ ] Written self-assessment against DLP Completion criteria (Craft, Evaluate, Iterate, Adopt)
- [ ] AI Adoption Maturity Assessment scored as part of the gate: target 3.0+ averages on dimensions 1–4, total score in the 43–58 range

REVIEWER DECISION

- **Pass** — Cleared for DLP engagement
- **Conditional pass** — Cleared with specific remediation items to complete before solo engagement
- **Not yet** — Specific gaps identified; recommended path to resubmission

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